



| How to start writing Data Science blogs?

| Thinking of blogging on Data Science? This one is for you.



](<https://medium.com/@rashidesai2424> "An Analytics Consultant from Chicago & Top 100 writer on Medium. Everyone loves a good story & I tell mine with data!")

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Towards Data Science

](<https://medium.com/towards-data-science> "Your home for data science.")androidstudio ~8 min read · June 4, 2020 (Updated: December 14, 2021) · Free: No

When we think about blogging, most of us are overwhelmed with the thought of writing perfect articles that can fetch views, not having enough knowledge on your part, lack of consistency or finding the right audience.

| There can be 100 reasons for failing, but 1 reason to succeed is enough!

I first heard about technology blogging at a conference in 2016. I was quite intrigued by the idea of putting your thoughts to the people. I initially began blogging on WordPress — stories about my days, feelings, hopes, achievements (that was easy). I had a pretty decent viewership (to my belief) for the first three months and reached 500 views. However, I wasn't quite enjoying the process and started exploring Blogger, Ghost.org, Tumblr, and such.

In 2017, I was learning the concepts of User Experience Design and came across this platform called [Medium](#) where I could find a plethora of articles across any topic I could think of in technology and personal development — from cryptocurrency to leadership, math to psychedelics, Medium was my place!

I started reading tons of articles and found Medium as one of the best platforms for writers and readers. With Medium's policies, basically, anyone who has something interesting to write about can become a writer. On July 13, 2017, I wrote my first article [Sales Prediction by UX Usability](#) on Medium.

While I wrote this article mostly for experimental purposes, the feeling of satisfaction that I derived when I got my first clap, that encouraged to continue writing.

It took me way more than a year to figure out how stories on Medium worked, what are publications, how to get more audience to engage with content, and thus began my journey as a full-time technology blogger from January 16, 2019, with no looking back. I had my first 1K+ views story 😊

| Advantages of blogging for data science

There are so many beginner, intermediate, and expert level enthusiasts out there who are sharing their knowledge and learnings with the community through blogs. What pulls them to write then?

1. Learn and share

I have always believed in *learn, explore, experience, share, repeat*.

I am constantly motivated to work on challenging data science projects or concepts, thereby improving my data skills. With data science blogs, you involve yourself in indirect mentoring. When someone reads your blog, they learn out of it, execute it, and feel satisfied with reading your content. You might never know that person personally but the idea of inspiring, teaching someone makes me excited to pay it forward!

2. Build your profile

A blog is undoubtedly one of the smartest means for you to showcase your knowledge and skills in data science.

Every article published on Medium can be considered intellectual property — inimitable, unique, and irreplaceable. You can definitely add the link to your medium profile on your resume (I have).

When you write, you are established as someone who knows something in data science, maybe not an expert but people reading your blogs will associate you with what you write. When people read your content, they see you in that light; which is a great thing for building your brand as a data scientist.

For me, writing about data science is a way to showcase my prowess to the world while it acts as a silent resume for me!

3. Global exposure

Articles on Medium are read by a global community. You have an opportunity to share your expertise, knowledge, learnings, and experiences with readers across the entire globe. When you have comments, emails, Twitter or LinkedIn DMs from people around the world, the glee is unparalleled.

4. Develop soft skills

If writing articles with ~1000 to 1500 words doesn't improve your communication skills, what will then? Blogging, taking the feedback into account enables you to convey information in a way that the general public can understand.

If you can't explain something to someone in simple terms, then it means you don't understand the concept well.

When someone reaches out to me and says they enjoy my easy-to-understand manner in which I explain concepts, that's what bloggers dream for!

5. Introduce yourself to numerous opportunities

When you write blogs on Medium, it builds credibility for you while your work becomes instantly available to the entire world. Anyone searching you or Googling some keywords and coming across your profile looks at the work you've done.

In my initial days of blogging, I wrote majorly about User Experience Design. A UX Designer from Germany reached out to me on Twitter reading a blog of mine on and he wanted to know if I would be interested in writing paid articles for their blog. So many people want to write for paid blogs but they don't have a portfolio to show. Your articles will act as a resume for you when the opportunity presents itself.

To now, I have had multiple opportunities to work on independent paid projects, attend conferences for free, guest blog for a publication across my journey.

6. Make money 💰

Did you know, you can make money from your articles (even about \$1000 per month). By means of the Medium Partner Program, anyone who publishes on Medium can make their articles eligible for earning money. Next, it depends on how engaging your article is to the audience for the earnings.

THE PROCESS

1. Select your domain

There are multiple things even in Data Science that you can blog about.

1. Data Science concepts — Decision Trees, Random Forests, SVM, kNN, Clustering, NLP, Deep Learning, Artificial Intelligence, and more...
2. Statistics and Math for Data Science
3. Projects — data cleaning, data wrangling, data
4. Data Analytics
5. Data Visualization

6. Research about Data Science (amazing for validation)
7. General topics — software, tools, news, programming languages, skills
8. Comparisons — job roles, libraries, functions
9. Tutorials
10. Case Study Analysis, etc...

These are some of the topics you can choose to write from for your first Data Science blog.

2. Research

If you think of a certain topic, there are tons of articles probably with the same title as you thought of on the internet. Not just Medium, but you need to take care that your content does not replicate any other article on the web, at least try to.

The core of writing blogs is providing value. If you are not educating a person on something that hasn't been told before, a reader might just bounce off your blog and approach a point of no return.

With Data Science especially, say you decide to write about Random Forest, there are about 611,000,000 results on Google (search for yourself). Your goal is to be unique, explain the concept in an easy-to-understand manner, cater to a wider audience, and rank high on Google search with good quality content.

My advice would be to research all existing content peripheral to your topic of interest, make notes, sketch out an outline of what you want to write. The more you read, the more you become clear of your content.

3. Understand your audience

Before publishing a blog, a good tip would be to understand what kind of audience are you delivering to — beginner, intermediate, expert. It is very important to validate that what you write will be consumed.

Initially, I used to submit to a publication, and even though I would consider it a work I can be proud of, it would not be read by many people. Problem: the writeup was too advanced and for some reason, irrelevant to the readers. Later, I had to stop submitting to that publication.

Read other blogs published peripheral to your topic for a content check!

4. Submit to a publication

[Publications](#) on Medium are shared spaces for stories written around a common theme or topic. Publications are looking for writers to propose up-to-date and relevant content focused on say data science, machine learning, artificial intelligence, programming, and much more.

There are guidelines for every publication to get accepted — that means if your content isn't of quality enough to be curated or doesn't follow the guidelines, it won't be published. Be sure to read the guidelines before submitting.

Once you are accepted, a publication enables you to reach a broader audience, earn more money, get honest feedback.

For Data Science, you can submit your articles to

1. [Towards Data Science](#)
2. [Towards AI](#)
3. [Becoming Human](#)
4. [ML Review](#)

5. Monitor your metrics

This I consider as the biggest learning tool — keeping a track of your views and reads. With every story you publish, there is a detailed statistics associated that tells you your readership across platforms.

The best feedback you can ever get is from closely monitoring your stats. Some blogs might do exceptionally well as 200K+views while some might limit to 3K views. That's when you introspect, find what worked and what did not work. Read the responses on your stories very well: from showing typos to appreciating tons — responses reflect the user outlook.

Then there is something called **Read Ratio**. You don't only want readers to see your blog but to READ it. Medium read ratio for a 5–7 minutes read time article or story is somewhere between 40% - 70% of read-ratio. The factors that influence the Medium read ratio are the source of traffic and the reading time of your Medium article.

Fans of clickbait titles would much play around the Read Ratio. But again, it depends on the purpose of you writing the blog.

6. Be patient

The key to increasing your blog traffic is: BE PATIENT. Success in blogging does not arrive at doorstep wrapped up in a pretty bow. It requires a lot of hard work and A LOT of patience. Uber blogger [Chris Brogan](#) famously said that it took him three years to attract his first 100, blog subscribers. After all, not everyone can be Justin Bieber to get overnight success 😊

1. Focus on creating the best possible content; insanely great content
2. Be yourself — make that your "competitive advantage"
3. Be consistent in writing
4. Handle criticism with grace — it's a sign of leaders
5. Occasionally take risks in what you write. It's okay to try new and fail!
6. Don't fear. Just publish it even if you're not sure of its "perfectness"

Thank you for reading! I hope you enjoyed the article and will start mind mapping to write a blog as of this moment. Do let me know what excites you in your Data Science blogging journey.

Happy Data Tenting!

Disclaimer: The views expressed in this article are my own and do not represent a strict outlook.

| Know your author

Rashi is a graduate student at the University of Illinois, Chicago. She loves to visualize data and create insightful stories. When not rushing to meet school deadlines, she adores writing about technology, UX, and more with a good cup of hot chocolate.